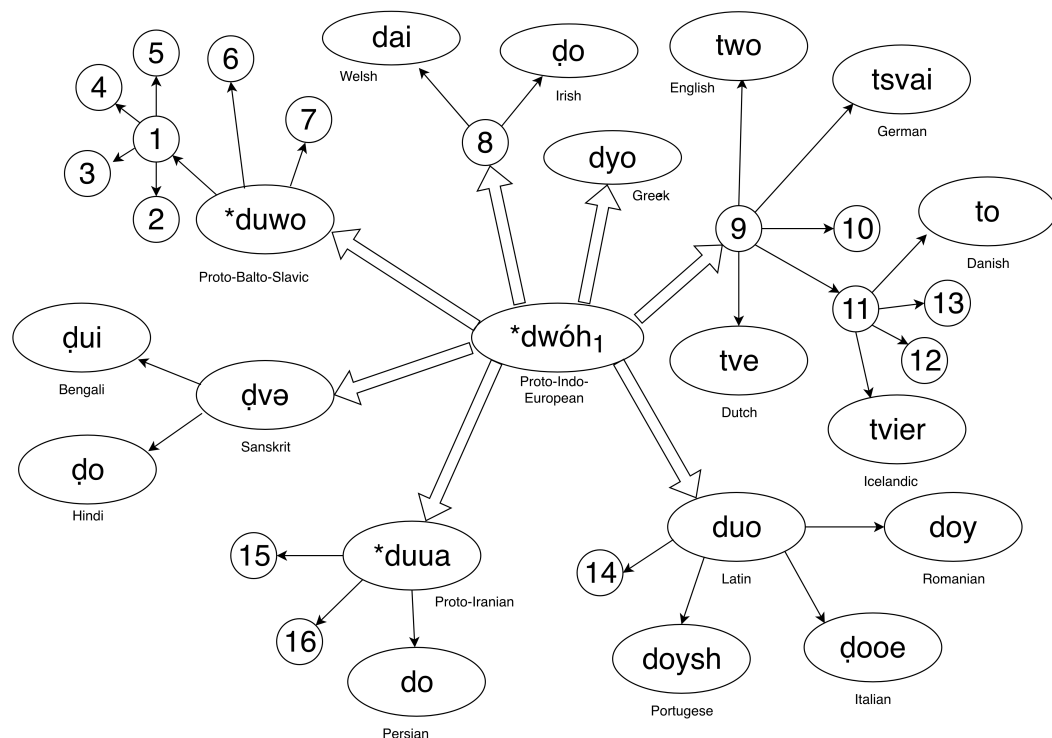


Problem 4: From Two to Two, Too

(14 marks)

One way that languages develop is through the evolution and gradual change of existing languages. Because of this process, like many other words, the word for the number 2 (“two”) is similar in many related languages. Research shows that the evolution chart may look like this (some words are missing):



In the chart, all words are spelled according to how they are pronounced. For example, do in Persian rhymes with ‘show’, unlike the English word ‘do’. The only exception to this is the English word ‘two’ which is spelled as normal but it is not pronounced with a ‘w’ sound. (Fun fact: around 1,000 years ago, the ‘w’ sound was actually present in English!) The character ‘ɖ’ indicates a ‘d’ sound produced near the teeth rather than the roof of the mouth, and the character ‘ə’ is the sound when you say ‘uhhh’.

Some languages have ‘proto-’ before them and the words are marked with *. This is because they are hypothetical languages that linguists have tried to reconstruct from historical evidence, and we are not sure about the words or the pronunciations; ‘proto-’

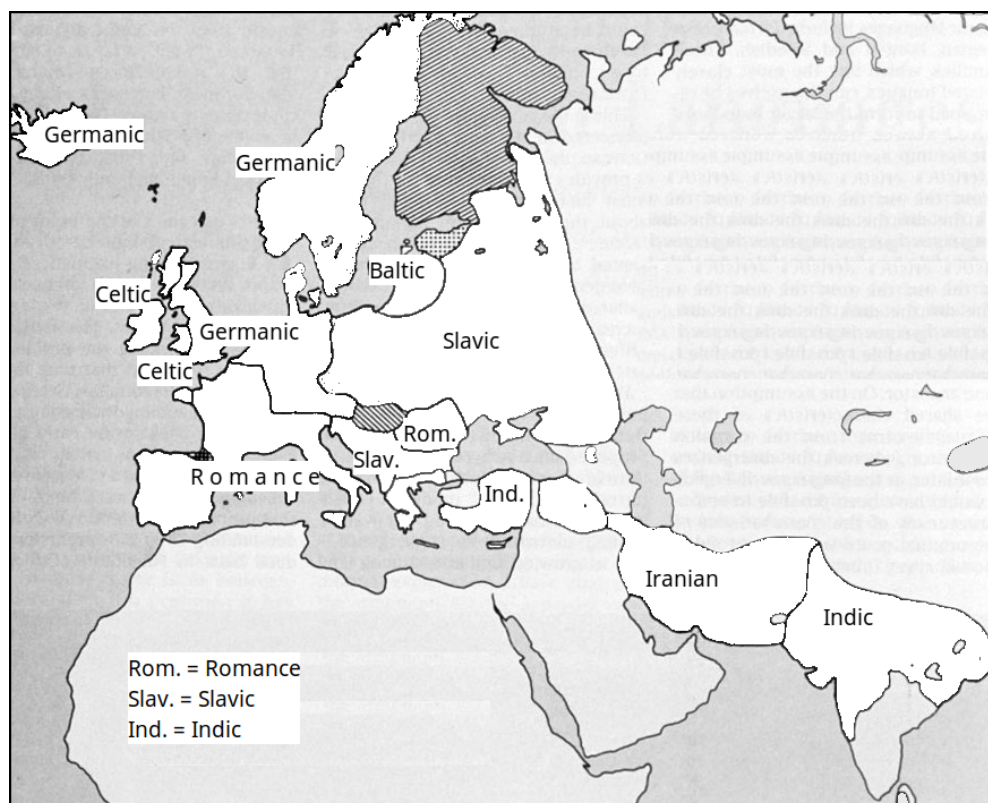
means something that came before, or the original form of something. 'Slavic', 'Baltic', 'Celtic', 'Germanic', 'Iranian', 'Indic', etc. are names of large language families.

Assignment 1: (14 marks)

Fill in the missing words numbered (1)–(16) in the chart above from the following list:

Word	Language	Word	Language
dva	Serbo-Croatian	*dwaw	Proto-Celtic
dva	Polish	tsvey	Yiddish
dva	Czech	*dva	Proto-Slavic
too	Norwegian	du	Lithuanian
dva	Russian	divi	Latvian
*twai	Proto-Germanic	do	Balochi
ðos	Spanish	du	Kurdish
tveir	Old Norse	tvo	Swedish

Hint: Kurdish and Balochi have evolved from the same language, and Lithuanian and Latvian are Baltic languages. Also, this map of language families may be useful.



– Mukund Choudhary and Shardul Chiplunkar